



Satish Mohan
Head-Engineering,
Red Hat India

We never sidestep security—smart cards are used across our seven locations in India. Travel being frequent, it's mandatory for employees to carry individual smart cards. Entry into the main office is enabled through smart cards. Our server facility is secured through a two-step access mechanism—using smart cards and biometric fingerprinting for enhanced security.

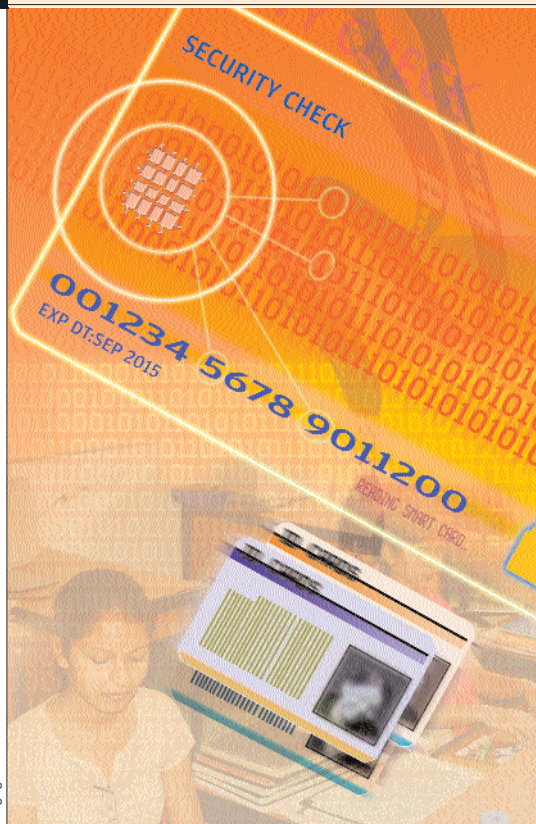
Only select personnel have secure access to the server facility. To log in, employees swipe the smart card and press their thumbs on the biometric fingerprint reader. Having a LAN interface, the smart card and biometric fingerprint devices can be networked without a computer.

Apart from employee identification, log in and log out data, 'timestamps' are recorded in a centralised Human Resource Information System that captures online, real time data generated nationwide, which can be accessed by the HR department from anywhere. Since they are long lasting and virtually maintenance free, smart cards are indeed a smart choice.



SMART ACCESS

Smart cards are being increasingly implemented in the workplace to record employee attendance, track their intra-office movement and maintain security. Is this just about security or is there more to it?



Piyush Gupta
GM Operations,
Television Eighteen

At present, the deployment of access cards—proximity or smart—is limited. However, we are in the process of installing the access control system across the company. Since we are a television channel (CNBC-TV18) and a production house, we have a fair amount of expensive equipment and gadgetry that needs to be kept away from unauthorised individuals.

Another problem is that certain areas in the office that are not in use through the day end up becoming meeting points, specifically server rooms and editing bays. Access control systems and smart cards will enable us to track the movement of employees in our restricted areas.

Installing a smart access system with restricted entry levels would prevent this occurrence. If need be, the concerned departments could also get a report of an individual's movement in office premises.

This would obviously increase productivity. As far as TV18 is concerned, rights to access different areas are decided by the Administration department, while the implementation is done by the Systems and IT department.